

Minority REPORT

Sweet 16 and never been kissed? That was yesterday. Today's adolescents are forging beyond foreplay.

Do you approve of
underage sex?

YES 26

NO **74**

Male 38, Female 14

Male 62, Female 86

All figures in per cent.

Whom did you have sex
with for the first time?

Partner	45	Male	Female
Boyfriend/Girlfriend	28	26	70
Casual acquaintance	3	37	16
One-night stand	3	5	2
Relative	4	5	1
Neighbour	9	4	4
Paid	3	13	4
Colleague	2	4	1
		3	2

For 3,923 respondents of the total of 5,353 who say they have had sex. Rest don't know/can't say. All figures in per cent.

In Hyderabad, 15 per cent men had their first sexual experience in a one-night stand. For women, the highest was 2 per cent in Chennai and Lucknow.



Photographs by BANDEEP SINGH

By Damayanti Datta

Watch her gyrate. Her body shapes like plasticine, bouncy-jiggly steps here, shimmying-strutting hips there. She pouts, she tugs at her jeans, she bares her thongs, eyes wide, crimson lipstick glistening in the arc-lights. No Bollywood diva, just a 14-year-old trying to sashay from a reality television talent show to national headlines. "It's because of my parents that I am here today," she says, tossing her thick curls and snapping on chewing gum. As the pyrotechnics fade and the dry-ice fog streaming over the studio audience dies out, the camera pans in on the parents—suburban and white-collared—the father beaming proudly and the mother silently mouthing the daughter's answers. It makes for uncomfortable viewing. But it's like holding up a mirror to the new realities of life that refuse to be nipped or tucked.

Sweet 16 and never been kissed? That was yesterday. The shifting contours of the post-globalisation family has created the New Teen. Brought up on an untested diet of western soap operas, cable tv and increasingly globalised values, those under 18, the age of consent, are defying every norm that has bound them